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ANDREW HARNIK/GETTY IMAGES

Calls to release all the Jeffrey Epstein files brought together a Democrat, Representative Ro Khanna, and some Republicans.

## Back after a break in the inaction

Congress returns to the usual problems, and the possible prospect of a shutdown

By Tal Kopan,  
Jackie Kucinich,  
and Julian E.J. Sorapuru  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As a group of conservative Republicans stood under a blue sky on Tuesday afternoon praising President Trump's federal takeover of law enforcement in the District of Columbia, a clutch of home-made protest signs began to peek over their suited shoulders. "Release All the Files!" was scrawled on one, as a large banner displayed black and white photos of Trump and Jeffrey Epstein.

It was a fitting start to September for Congress, which is returning to a National Guard-fortified capital with rapidly approaching deadlines for its to-do list, undimmed enmity for the other party, and an administration still prone to suddenly upending their carefully laid plans. And the problems members



CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

Chauntae Davies (right) embraced Anouska De Georgiou at the news conference. Both are survivors of Epstein.

of Congress left behind during the extended summer break — most obviously the outcry over the files from the sex trafficking investigation into Epstein — were right there waiting for

them. Neither party is immune: Both are staring down a Sept. 30 deadline to fund the government, already pre-blaming each other for a potential shutdown.

Democrats are under pressure from their base to withhold votes for a funding deal to extract promises from the administration, while Republicans are grousing about White House efforts to claw back funding they appropriated last year while they're negotiating spending plans for next year.

And there is no respite in sight, as hearings over contentious nominees and upheaval at the country's public health bureaucracy under Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. are on the calendar in the coming days. The main event on Wednesday was near impossible to miss. Just outside of the Capitol, hundreds of protesters and journalists gathered around a small lectern overlaid with a sign that read, "Epstein Files Transparency Act."

An unlikely coalition of lawmakers formed: Representatives

D.C., Page A6

## Shooting survivors, victims' kin sue government

Say military ignored Lewiston gunman's warning signs

By Nick Stoico  
and Travis Andersen  
GLOBE STAFF

Survivors of the mass shooting in Lewiston, Maine, and relatives of the 18 people killed sued the federal government on Wednesday, alleging that military officials failed to respond to numerous warning signs that the gunman, an Army reservist, posed "an imminent risk of violence."

"This case arises from one of the most preventable mass tragedies in American history — a mass shooting that could and should have been stopped by the United States Army months before Robert Card terrorized Maine on October 25, 2023," the lawsuit stated.

At a news conference in Lewiston, Cynthia Young, who lost her husband, William, and her 14-year-old son, Aaron, in the shootings, became visibly emotional as she described the toll the rampage has taken on her family and on the other victims.

"We lost something precious," Young said. "Some of us lost our

loved ones. Some of us have lost the ability to feel safe or secure. The one thing we all lost was our trust in those who are responsible."

Young said that "losing both my husband and my child in a tragedy that never should have happened is a pain beyond words. We trusted those in power to protect our loved ones. And their inaction cost us everything. No family should have to endure this heartache when so many signs were ignored."

It's "not fair that their lives were cut so short," Young said. "They both had so much to still give this world, and in a moment they were gone."

The lawsuit, filed in federal court in Maine, said the shootings at a Lewiston bowling alley and restaurant, which left 18 people dead and 13 injured, "could and should have been stopped by the United States Army."

"The evidence we've gathered in the wake of this tragedy is disturbing," Travis M. Brennan, one of the lawyers for the 100 plaintiffs, said at the news conference.

Another plaintiff, Ben Dyer, who lost a finger on his right hand in the attack, said he was shot five times and couldn't work for 18 months.

"Physically, my body wouldn't

LEWISTON, Page A5

## Trump's efforts have sucked wind out of the industry's sails in N.E.

By Sabrina Shankman  
GLOBE STAFF

Just 12 months ago, New England was braced for a sea change in its energy mix, with at least seven massive wind farms proposed for the coastal waters just offshore — the first of which to be completed this year.

That scale of development was supposed to be game-changing, policy makers and energy experts said, as New England has limited access to energy supplies, and some of the highest electricity rates in the country. But just over eight months

into Trump's presidency, all but one has been stopped in its tracks, and that last one is facing stiffening political headwinds.

In rapid-fire fashion, the Trump administration moved to slow or outright stop offshore wind in New England. It filed court orders to revoke permits for three projects that, when fully built, would have provided enough energy to power 1.7 million homes in Massachusetts and Rhode Island. It also canceled \$679 million in federal funds for port infrastructure related to the wind farms, and issued a stop-work order for Revo-

lution Wind in Rhode Island, which was under construction and around 80 percent done.

"The attacks from the Trump administration have been relentless, and they seem to be gaining speed in recent weeks and days," said Kat Burnham, a senior principal at Advanced Energy United, a Washington, D.C.-based trade group representing clean energy, transmission, technology and transportation companies.

Now, rather than an industry on the verge of a boom, offshore wind on the East Coast is in real

OFFSHORE WIND, Page A7

Shannon O'Brien's rein-statement to the Cannabis Control Commission may wind up in court, after Treasurer Deborah Goldberg said she'll appeal the ruling. **D1.**

Attorney General Andrea Campbell certified nearly four dozen ballot petitions, although not all of them will go before voters. **B1.**

A federal appellate court ruled that President Trump unlawfully invoked a centuries-old wartime law to swiftly deport Venezuelan migrants. **A2.**

China's Xi Jinping presided over a massive military parade in Beijing as he issued a warning to rivals. **A3.**



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

### Injury puts Anthony on the shelf

Red Sox face a challenge with star rookie out for a few weeks. **C1.**

### Before the fall

**Thursday:** Sunny, pleasant. High 74-79. Low 62-67.

**Friday:** Humid for once. High 81-86. Low 66-71.

Sunrise: 6:13 Sunset: 7:13  
**Weather and Comics, D6.**

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